expansion involves establishing three new facilities in southern India. Zetwerk is likely to collaborate with existing production-linked incentive holders to enter the IT and hardware sector, positioning itself competitively in the market. Besides laptops, Zetwerk has also added televisions to its production line, but it primarily functions as a contract manufacturer for other brands, without plans to sell products under its own brand name. The company anticipates significant growth in the consumer electronics segment, projecting a seven-fold increase in revenue compared to the previous year.

SNIPPETS

- Kerala State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) to add 60 new e-buses to the fleet
- Battery recycling firm, RecycleKaro, to invest ₹1 billion in Maharashtra
- Kaynes partners with Karnataka government to boost electronics manufacturing
- AMD acquires Mipsology to boost AI software capabilities
- Jean-Marc Chery to continue overseeing STMicroelectronics' operations
- Advait Infratech Limited and GuoFu Hydrogen Energy Equipment join forces to advance green hydrogen technology in India
- Schwing Stetter India enters into a partnership with a Chennai engineering college to launch a 1-year internship program
- Qualcomm collaborating with EE and Charter to expand its presence in the Wi-Fi router segment

TATA Elxsi, NIT Calicut invest ₹10 million for EV research lab

The National Institute of Technology Calicut (NITC) and TATA Elxsi have entered into a memorandum of understanding to collaborate on electric vehicle (EV) research. A new laboratory will be established at NITC through a ₹10 million investment, with ₹7.5 million contributed by TATA Elxsi and ₹2.5 million by the institute. The partnership aims to address EV challenges such as electricity shortages, high EV costs, and charging infrastructure issues in Kerala. The laboratory will empower students and faculty to work on EV-related challenges.

'Make-in-India' spurs 2 billion mobile phone production in India

India has become the world's second-largest mobile phone producer, with over 2 billion units manufactured, thanks to the 'Make in India' initiative, domestic demand, digital literacy growth, and government programs. Mobile phone production grew at over a 23% compound annual growth rate (CAGR) between 2014 and 2022. In 2022, 98% of mobile phone shipments in India were 'Made in India,' a significant increase from 19% in 2014. Local value addition in India increased to an average of over 15%. Initiatives like the Phased Manufacturing Program and higher import duties on finished units promote local production and value addition.

US tech majors protest India's laptop import curbs

Major US tech companies, including Google, Apple, Dell, HP, and Lenovo, are urging the US government to use all available means to persuade India to reconsider implementing import restrictions on IT hardware. This move is in response to India categorising tablets, laptops, and other electronics as restricted items, requiring additional licenses for import without prior consultation. Eight American trade bodies, including the Semiconductor Industry Association, Information Technology Industry Council, and United States Council for International Business, have expressed their concerns to the US Trade Representative, urging it to engage and ensure that India's measures in the ICT (information and communication technology) sector align with its international trade obligations and commitments.

Government planning nine more supercomputers

The Indian government unveiled its plans to add nine more supercomputers under the National Supercomputer Mission to enhance digital delivery to citizens. The AI supercomputer 'AIRAWAT' at C-DAC, Pune, ranks seventy-fifth globally and is India's largest and fastest AI supercomputing system. It operates at a speed of 13,170 teraflops and is powered by an AMD EPYC 7742 processor with 81,344 cores, running on the Ubuntu 20.04.2 LTS operating system. In addition to AIRAWAT, there are three other Indian supercomputers among the world's 500 fastest: PARAM Siddhi-AI supercomputer (131), at C-DAC, Pune, Pratyush supercomputer (169), at Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, and Mihir (316), a Cray XC40 machine, at the National Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasting and powered by Xeon E5-2695v4 processors.

Toppan sets up catalyst coated membrane production equipment at Kochi plant

Japanese electronics printing solutions provider Toppan has installed production equipment for catalyst coated membrane (CCM)/membrane electrode assemblies (MEA) at its Kochi plant to mass-produce sheet-type CCM/MEAs. The newly installed equipment uses a proprietary manufacturing method, allowing direct coating of both sides of the electrolyte membrane, enhancing the CCM/MEA durability by controlling the porosity of catalyst layers and adjusting the degree of ease with which water generated by hydrogen use can be discharged. This results in mass production of high-performance, high-output CCM/MEAs, essential components for hydrogen production, storage, transportation, and fuel cells, improving overall performance.